

The Economist Democracy Index

The **Democracy Index** published by the Economist Group is an index measuring the quality of democracy across the world. This quantitative and comparative assessment is centrally concerned with democratic rights and democratic institutions. The methodology for assessing democracy used in this democracy index is according to the Economist Intelligence Unit which is part of the Economist Group, a UK-based private company, which publishes the weekly newspaper *The Economist*. The index is based on 60 indicators grouped into five categories, measuring pluralism, civil liberties, and political culture. In addition to a numeric score and a ranking, the index categorizes each country into one of four regime types: full democracies, flawed democracies, hybrid regimes, and authoritarian regimes. The first Democracy Index report was published in 2006. Reports were published every two years until 2010 and annually thereafter. The index includes 167 countries and territories, of which 165 are sovereign states and 164 are UN member states. Other democracy indices with similar assessments of the state of democracy^[1] include V-Dem Democracy indices or Bertelsmann Transformation Index.

Methodology

As described in the report, the *Democracy Index* produces a weighted average based on the answers to 60 questions, or indicators, each one with either two or three permitted answers. Most answers are experts' assessments. Some answers are provided by public-opinion surveys from the respective countries. In the case of countries for which survey results are missing, survey results for similar countries and expert assessments are used in order to fill in gaps.^[2]

The questions are grouped into five categories:

- electoral process and pluralism (12 indicators)
- functioning of government (14 indicators)
- political participation (9 indicators)
- political culture (8 indicators)
- civil liberties (17 indicators)

Each answer is converted to a score, either 0 or 1, or for the three-answer questions, 0, 0.5 or 1. With the exceptions mentioned below, within each category, the scores are added, multiplied by ten, and divided by the total number of questions within the category. There are a few modifying dependencies, which are explained much more precisely than the main rule procedures. In a few cases, an answer yielding zero for one question voids another question; e.g., if the elections for the national legislature and head of government are not considered free (question 1), then the next question, "Are elections... fair?", is not considered, but automatically scored zero. Likewise, there are a few questions considered so important that a low score on them yields a penalty on the total score sum for their respective categories, namely:

- "Whether national elections are free and fair";
- "The security of voters";
- "The influence of foreign powers on government";
- "The capability of the civil servants to implement policies".

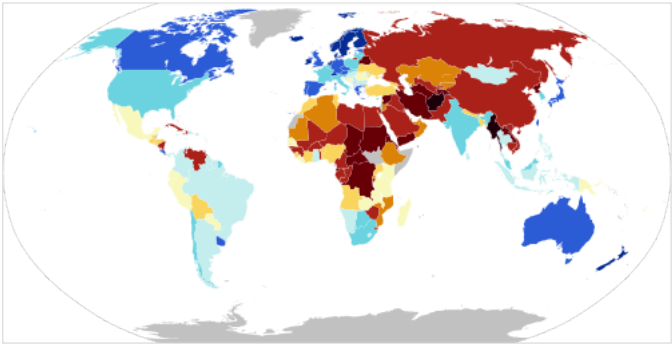
The five category indices, which are listed in the report, are then averaged to find the overall score for a given country. Finally, the score, rounded to two decimals, decides the regime-type classification of the country.

The report discusses other indices of democracy, as defined, e.g., by Freedom House, and argues for some of the choices made by the team from the Economist Intelligence Unit. In this comparison, a higher emphasis is placed on the public opinion and attitudes, as measured by surveys, but on the other hand, economic living-standards are not weighted as one criterion of democracy (as seemingly some other investigators have done).^{[3][4]}

The report is widely cited in the international press as well as in peer-reviewed academic journals.^[5]

Definitions

- Full democracies are countries where civil liberties and fundamental political freedoms are not only respected but also reinforced by a political culture conducive to the thriving of democratic principles. These nations have a valid system of governmental checks and balances, an independent judiciary whose decisions are enforced, governments that function adequately, and diverse and independent media. These nations have only limited problems in democratic functioning.^[6]
- Flawed democracies are countries where elections are fair and free and basic civil liberties are honoured, but may have issues (e.g. media freedom infringement and minor suppression of political opposition and critics). These countries can have significant faults in other



The 2024 Economist Intelligence Unit *Democracy Index* map

Full democracies

- 9.00–10.00
- 8.00–8.99

No data

Flawed democracies

- 7.00–7.99
- 6.00–6.99

Hybrid regimes

- 5.00–5.99
- 4.00–4.99

Authoritarian regimes

- 3.00–3.99
- 2.00–2.99
- 1.00–1.99
- 0.00–0.99

- democratic aspects, including an underdeveloped political culture, low levels of participation in politics, and issues in the functioning of governance.^[6]
- **Hybrid regimes** are countries with regular electoral fraud, preventing them from being fair and free democracies. These countries commonly have non-independent judiciaries, widespread corruption, and weak rule of law. Political opponents and the media face harassment and pressure from governments. These countries have a less-developed political culture, lower levels of participation in politics, and more pronounced issues in the functioning of governance compared to flawed democracies.^[6]
 - **Authoritarian regimes** are countries where political pluralism is nonexistent or severely limited. These nations are often absolute monarchies or dictatorships and may have some conventional institutions of democracy but with meagre significance. Infringements and abuses of civil liberties are commonplace, elections (if they take place) are not fair or free (especially sham elections), the media is often state-owned or controlled by groups associated with the ruling regime, the judiciary is not independent, and censorship and suppression of governmental criticism are commonplace.^[6]

By regime type

The following table indicates the number of nations and the percentage of world population for each type of regime. Some microstates are not considered in the calculation.

Year 2024 ^[7]						
Type of regime	Score		Countries		Proportion of world population (%)	
	2022–2024	2006–2021	Number	(%)w	By types	Subtotal
Full democracies	9.00–10.00 8.00–8.99	9.01–10.00 8.01–9.00	25	15.0%	6.6%	45%
Flawed democracies	7.00–7.99 6.00–6.99	7.01–8.00 6.01–7.00	46	27.5%	38.4%	
Hybrid regimes	5.00–5.99 4.00–4.99	5.01–6.00 4.01–5.00	36	21.6%	15.7%	54.9%
Authoritarian regimes	3.00–3.99 2.00–2.99 1.00–1.99 0.00–0.99	3.01–4.00 2.01–3.00 1.01–2.00 0.00–1.00	60	35.9%	39.2%	

List by region

The following table lists the average of each country scored by geographic region, as defined by the Economist Democracy Index.

	Region	Coun-tries	2024	2023	2022	2021	2020	2019	2018	2017	2016	2015	2014	2013	2012	2011	2010	2008	2006
1	<u>Western Europe</u>	<u>21</u>																	
2	<u>North America</u>	<u>2</u>																	
3	<u>Latin America and the Caribbean</u>	<u>24</u>	5.61	5.68	5.79	5.83	6.09	6.13	6.24	6.26	6.33	6.37	6.36	6.38	6.36	6.35	6.37	6.43	6.37
4	<u>Eastern Europe and Central Asia</u>	<u>28</u>	5.35	5.37	5.39	5.36	5.36	5.42	5.42	5.40	5.43	5.55	5.58	5.53	5.51	5.50	5.55	5.67	5.76
5	<u>Asia and Australasia</u>	<u>28</u>	5.31	5.41	5.46	5.62	5.67	5.67	5.67	5.63	5.74	5.74	5.70	5.61	5.56	5.51	5.53	5.58	5.44
6	<u>Sub-Saharan Africa</u>	<u>44</u>	4.00	4.04	4.14	4.12	4.16	4.26	4.36	4.35	4.37	4.38	4.34	4.36	4.33	4.32	4.23	4.28	4.24
7	<u>Middle East and North Africa</u>	<u>20</u>	3.12	3.23	3.34	3.41	3.44	3.53	3.54	3.54	3.56	3.58	3.65	3.68	3.73	3.62	3.52	3.48	3.54
	World	167	5.17	5.23	5.29	5.28	5.37	5.44	5.48	5.48	5.52	5.55	5.55	5.53	5.52	5.49	5.46	5.55	5.52

The following table lists the number of countries in each of the four democracy classifications.

Year 2024							
Rank	Region	Countries	Authoritarian	Hybrid regime	Flawed democracy	Full democracy	Average score
1	Western Europe	21	0	1	5	15	
2	North America	2	0	0	1	1	
3	Latin America and the Caribbean	24	4	8	10	2	5.61
4	Asia and Australasia	28	8	6	10	4	5.31
5	Eastern Europe and Central Asia	28	8	5	13	2	5.35
6	Sub-Saharan Africa	44	23	14	6	1	4.00
7	Middle East and North Africa	20	17	2	1	0	3.12
	World	167	60	36	46	25	5.17

List by country

The following table shows each nation's score over the years. The regions are assigned by the Economist Intelligence Unit, and may differ from conventional

classifications (for example, Turkey is grouped in Western Europe).

Regions

Asia and Australasia · Eastern Europe and Central Asia · Latin America and the Caribbean · Middle East and North Africa · North America · Sub-Saharan Africa · Western Europe

Region	2024 rank	Country	Regime type	2024	2023	2022	2021	2020	2019	2018	2017	2016	2015	2014	2013	2012	2011	2010
Asia and Australasia	167	 Afghanistan	Authoritarian	0.25	0.26	0.32	0.32	2.85	2.85	2.97	2.55	2.55	2.77	2.77	2.48	2.48	2.48	2.48
	11	 Australia	Full democracy	8.85	8.66	8.71	8.90	8.96	9.09	9.09	9.09	9.01	9.01	9.01	9.13	9.22	9.22	9.22
	100	 Bangladesh	Hybrid regime	4.44	5.87	5.99	5.99	5.99	5.88	5.57	5.43	5.73	5.73	5.78	5.86	5.86	5.86	5.87
	79	 Bhutan	Hybrid regime	5.65	5.54	5.54	5.71	5.71	5.30	5.30	5.08	4.93	4.93	4.87	4.82	4.65	4.57	4.68
	123	 Cambodia	Authoritarian	2.94	3.05	3.18	2.90	3.10	3.53	3.59	3.63	4.27	4.27	4.78	4.60	4.96	4.87	4.87
	145	 China	Authoritarian	2.11	2.12	1.94	2.21	2.27	2.26	3.32	3.10	3.18	3.14	3.00	3.00	3.00	3.14	3.14
	81	 Fiji	Hybrid regime	5.39	5.55	5.55	5.61	5.72	5.85	5.85	5.85	5.64	5.69	5.61	3.61	3.67	3.67	3.62
	87	 Hong Kong	Hybrid regime	5.09	5.24	5.28	5.60	5.57	6.02	6.15	6.31	6.42	6.50	6.46	6.42	6.42	5.92	5.92
	41	 India	Flawed democracy	7.29	7.18	7.04	6.91	6.61	6.90	7.23	7.23	7.81	7.74	7.92	7.69	7.52	7.30	7.28
	59	 Indonesia	Flawed democracy	6.44	6.53	6.71	6.71	6.30	6.48	6.39	6.39	6.97	7.03	6.95	6.82	6.76	6.53	6.53
	16	 Japan	Full democracy	8.48	8.40	8.33	8.15	8.13	7.99	7.99	7.88	7.99	7.96	8.08	8.08	8.08	8.08	8.08
	160	 Laos	Authoritarian	1.71	1.71	1.77	1.77	1.77	2.14	2.37	2.37	2.37	2.21	2.21	2.21	2.32	2.10	2.10
	44	 Malaysia	Flawed democracy	7.11	7.29	7.30	7.24	7.19	7.16	6.88	6.54	6.54	6.43	6.49	6.49	6.41	6.19	6.19
	53	 Mongolia	Flawed democracy	6.53	6.48	6.35	6.42	6.48	6.50	6.50	6.50	6.62	6.62	6.62	6.51	6.35	6.23	6.36
	166	 Myanmar	Authoritarian	0.96	0.85	0.74	1.02	3.04	3.55	3.83	3.83	4.20	4.14	3.05	2.76	2.35	1.77	1.77
	96	 Nepal	Hybrid regime	4.60	4.60	4.49	4.41	5.22	5.28	5.18	5.18	4.86	4.77	4.77	4.77	4.16	4.24	4.24
	2	 New Zealand	Full democracy	9.61	9.61	9.61	9.37	9.25	9.26	9.26	9.26	9.26	9.26	9.26	9.26	9.26	9.26	9.26
	165	 North Korea	Authoritarian	1.08	1.08	1.08	1.08	1.08	1.08	1.08	1.08	1.08	1.08	1.08	1.08	1.08	1.08	1.08
	124	 Pakistan	Authoritarian	2.84	3.25	4.13	4.31	4.31	4.25	4.17	4.26	4.33	4.40	4.64	4.64	4.57	4.55	4.55
	73	 Papua New Guinea	Hybrid regime	5.97	6.03	5.97	6.10	6.10	6.03	6.03	6.03	6.03	6.03	6.03	6.36	6.32	6.32	6.54
	51	 Philippines	Flawed democracy	6.63	6.66	6.73	6.62	6.56	6.64	6.71	6.71	6.94	6.84	6.77	6.41	6.30	6.12	6.12
	68	 Singapore	Flawed democracy	6.18	6.18	6.22	6.23	6.03	6.02	6.38	6.32	6.38	6.14	6.03	5.92	5.88	5.89	5.89
	32	 South Korea	Flawed democracy	7.75	8.09	8.03	8.16	8.01	8.00	8.00	8.00	7.92	7.97	8.06	8.06	8.13	8.06	8.11
	67	 Sri Lanka	Flawed democracy	6.19	6.17	6.47	6.14	6.14	6.27	6.19	6.48	6.48	6.42	5.69	5.69	5.75	6.58	6.64
	12	 Taiwan	Full democracy	8.78	8.92	8.99	8.99	8.94	7.73	7.73	7.73	7.79	7.83	7.65	7.57	7.57	7.46	7.52
	63	 Thailand	Flawed democracy	6.27	6.35	6.67	6.04	6.04	6.32	4.63	4.63	4.92	5.09	5.39	6.25	6.55	6.55	6.55
	46	 Timor-Leste	Flawed democracy	7.03	7.06	7.06	7.06	7.06	7.19	7.19	7.19	7.24	7.24	7.24	7.24	7.16	7.22	7.22
	133	 Vietnam	Authoritarian	2.62	2.62	2.73	2.94	2.94	3.08	3.08	3.08	3.38	3.53	3.41	3.29	2.89	2.96	2.94
Eastern Europe and Central Asia	66	 Albania	Flawed democracy	6.20	6.28	6.41	6.11	6.08	5.89	5.98	5.98	5.91	5.91	5.67	5.67	5.67	5.81	5.86
	82	 Armenia	Hybrid regime	5.35	5.42	5.63	5.49	5.35	5.54	4.79	4.11	3.88	4.00	4.13	4.02	4.09	4.09	4.09
	126	 Azerbaijan	Authoritarian	2.80	2.80	2.87	2.68	2.68	2.75	2.65	2.65	2.65	2.71	2.83	3.06	3.15	3.15	3.15
	152	 Belarus	Authoritarian	1.99	1.99	1.99	2.41	2.59	2.48	3.13	3.13	3.54	3.62	3.69	3.04	3.04	3.16	3.34
	88	 Bosnia and Herzegovina	Hybrid regime	5.06	5.00	5.00	5.04	4.84	4.86	4.98	4.87	4.87	4.83	4.78	5.02	5.11	5.24	5.32
	61	 Bulgaria	Flawed democracy	6.34	6.41	6.53	6.64	6.71	7.03	7.03	7.03	7.01	7.14	6.73	6.83	6.72	6.78	6.84

56	 Croatia	Flawed democracy	6.50	6.50	6.50	6.50	6.50	6.57	6.57	6.63	6.75	6.93	6.93	6.93	6.93	6.73	6.81
23	 Czech Republic	Full democracy	8.08	7.97	7.97	7.74	7.67	7.69	7.69	7.62	7.82	7.94	7.94	8.06	8.19	8.19	8.19
21	 Estonia	Full democracy	8.13	7.96	7.96	7.84	7.84	7.90	7.97	7.79	7.85	7.85	7.74	7.61	7.61	7.61	7.68
94	 Georgia	Hybrid regime	4.70	5.20	5.20	5.12	5.31	5.42	5.50	5.93	5.93	5.88	5.82	5.95	5.53	4.74	4.59
54	 Hungary	Flawed democracy	6.51	6.72	6.64	6.50	6.56	6.63	6.63	6.64	6.72	6.84	6.90	6.96	6.96	7.04	7.21
118	 Kazakhstan	Authoritarian	3.08	3.08	3.08	3.08	3.14	2.94	2.94	3.06	3.06	3.06	3.17	3.06	2.95	3.24	3.30
111	 Kyrgyzstan	Authoritarian	3.52	3.70	3.62	3.62	4.21	4.89	5.11	5.11	4.93	5.33	5.24	4.69	4.69	4.34	4.31
33	 Latvia	Flawed democracy	7.66	7.38	7.37	7.31	7.24	7.49	7.38	7.25	7.31	7.37	7.48	7.05	7.05	7.05	7.05
36	 Lithuania	Flawed democracy	7.59	7.31	7.31	7.18	7.13	7.50	7.50	7.41	7.47	7.54	7.54	7.54	7.24	7.24	7.24
71	 Moldova	Flawed democracy	6.04	6.23	6.23	6.10	5.78	5.75	5.85	5.94	6.01	6.35	6.32	6.32	6.32	6.32	6.33
50	 Montenegro	Flawed democracy	6.73	6.67	6.45	6.02	5.77	5.65	5.74	5.69	5.72	6.01	5.94	5.94	6.05	6.15	6.27
62	 North Macedonia	Flawed democracy	6.28	6.03	6.10	6.03	5.89	5.97	5.87	5.57	5.23	6.02	6.25	6.16	6.16	6.16	6.16
39	 Poland	Flawed democracy	7.40	7.18	7.04	6.80	6.85	6.62	6.67	6.67	6.83	7.09	7.47	7.12	7.12	7.12	7.05
72	 Romania	Hybrid regime	5.99	6.45	6.45	6.43	6.40	6.49	6.38	6.44	6.62	6.68	6.68	6.54	6.54	6.54	6.60
150	 Russia	Authoritarian	2.03	2.22	2.28	3.24	3.31	3.11	2.94	3.17	3.24	3.31	3.39	3.59	3.74	3.92	4.26
64	 Serbia	Flawed democracy	6.26	6.33	6.33	6.36	6.22	6.41	6.41	6.41	6.57	6.71	6.71	6.67	6.33	6.33	6.33
42	 Slovakia	Flawed democracy	7.21	7.07	7.07	7.03	6.97	7.17	7.10	7.16	7.29	7.29	7.35	7.35	7.35	7.35	7.35
30	 Slovenia	Flawed democracy	7.82	7.75	7.75	7.54	7.54	7.50	7.50	7.50	7.51	7.57	7.57	7.88	7.88	7.76	7.69
159	 Tajikistan	Authoritarian	1.83	1.94	1.94	1.94	1.94	1.93	1.93	1.93	1.89	1.95	2.37	2.51	2.51	2.51	2.51
161	 Turkmenistan	Authoritarian	1.66	1.66	1.66	1.66	1.72	1.72	1.72	1.72	1.83	1.83	1.83	1.72	1.72	1.72	1.72
92	 Ukraine	Hybrid regime	4.90	5.06	5.42	5.57	5.81	5.90	5.69	5.69	5.70	5.70	5.42	5.84	5.91	5.94	6.

	84	 Mexico	Hybrid regime	5.32	5.14	5.25	5.57	6.07	6.09	6.19	6.41	6.47	6.55	6.68	6.91	6.90	6.93	6.93
	147	 Nicaragua	Authoritarian	2.09	2.26	2.50	2.69	3.60	3.55	3.63	4.66	4.81	5.26	5.32	5.46	5.56	5.56	5.73
	47	 Panama	Flawed democracy	6.84	6.91	6.91	6.85	7.18	7.05	7.05	7.08	7.13	7.19	7.08	7.08	7.08	7.08	7.15
	75	 Paraguay	Hybrid regime	5.92	6.00	5.89	5.86	6.18	6.24	6.24	6.31	6.27	6.33	6.26	6.26	6.26	6.40	6.40
	78	 Peru	Hybrid regime	5.69	5.81	5.92	6.09	6.53	6.60	6.60	6.49	6.65	6.58	6.54	6.54	6.47	6.59	6.40
	48	 Suriname	Flawed democracy	6.79	6.88	6.95	6.82	6.82	6.98	6.98	6.76	6.77	6.77	6.77	6.77	6.65	6.65	6.65
	45	 Trinidad and Tobago	Flawed democracy	7.09	7.16	7.16	7.16	7.16	7.16	7.16	7.04	7.10	7.10	6.99	6.99	6.99	7.16	7.16
	15	 Uruguay	Full democracy	8.67	8.66	8.91	8.85	8.61	8.38	8.38	8.12	8.17	8.17	8.17	8.17	8.17	8.17	8.10
	142	 Venezuela	Authoritarian	2.25	2.31	2.23	2.11	2.76	2.88	3.16	3.87	4.68	5.00	5.07	5.07	5.15	5.08	5.18
Middle East and North Africa	110	 Algeria	Authoritarian	3.55	3.66	3.66	3.77	3.77	4.01	3.50	3.56	3.56	3.95	3.83	3.83	3.83	3.44	3.44
	138	 Bahrain	Authoritarian	2.45	2.52	2.52	2.52	2.49	2.55	2.71	2.71	2.79	2.79	2.87	2.87	2.53	2.92	3.49
	128	 Egypt	Authoritarian	2.79	2.93	2.93	2.93	2.93	3.06	3.36	3.36	3.31	3.18	3.16	3.27	4.56	3.95	3.07
	154	 Iran	Authoritarian	1.96	1.96	1.96	1.95	2.20	2.38	2.45	2.45	2.34	2.16	1.98	1.98	1.98	1.98	1.94
	126	 Iraq	Authoritarian	2.80	2.88	3.13	3.51	3.62	3.74	4.06	4.09	4.08	4.08	4.23	4.10	4.10	4.03	4.00
	31	 Israel	Flawed democracy	7.80	7.80	7.93	7.97	7.84	7.86	7.79	7.79	7.85	7.77	7.63	7.53	7.53	7.53	7.48
	115	 Jordan	Authoritarian	3.28	3.04	3.17	3.49	3.62	3.93	3.93	3.87	3.96	3.86	3.76	3.76	3.76	3.89	3.74
	130	 Kuwait	Authoritarian	2.78	3.50	3.83	3.91	3.80	3.93	3.85	3.85	3.85	3.85	3.78	3.78	3.78	3.74	3.88
	109	 Lebanon	Authoritarian	3.56	3.56	3.64	3.84	4.16	4.36	4.63	4.72	4.86	4.86	5.12	5.05	5.05	5.32	5.82
	140	 Libya	Authoritarian	2.31	1.78	2.06	1.95	1.95	2.02	2.19	2.32	2.25	2.25	3.80	4.82	5.15	3.55	1.94
	91	 Morocco	Hybrid regime	4.97	5.04	5.04	5.04	5.04	5.10	4.99	4.87	4.77	4.66	4.00	4.07	4.07	3.83	3.79
	120	 Oman	Authoritarian	3.05	3.12	3.12	3.00	3.00	3.06	3.04	3.04	3.04	3.04	3.15	3.26	3.26	3.26	2.86
	112	 Palestine	Authoritarian	3.44	3.47	3.86	3.94	3.83	3.89	4.39	4.46	4.49	4.57	4.72	4.80	4.80	4.97	5.44
	117	 Qatar	Authoritarian	3.17	3.65	3.65	3.65	3.24	3.19	3.19	3.19	3.18	3.18	3.18	3.18	3.18	3.18	3.09
	148	 Saudi Arabia	Authoritarian	2.08	2.08	2.08	2.08	2.08	1.93	1.93	1.93	1.93	1.93	1.82	1.82	1.71	1.77	1.84
	162	 Sudan	Authoritarian	1.46	1.76	2.47	2.47	2.54	2.70	2.15	2.15	2.37	2.37	2.54	2.54	2.38	2.38	2.42
	163	 Syria	Authoritarian	1.32	1.43	1.43	1.43	1.43	1.43	1.43	1.43	1.43	1.43	1.74	1.86	1.63	1.99	2.31
	93	 Tunisia	Hybrid regime	4.71	5.51	5.51	5.99	6.59	6.72	6.41	6.32	6.40	6.72	6.31	5.76	5.67	5.53	2.79
	119	 United Arab Emirates	Authoritarian	3.07	3.01	2.90	2.90	2.70	2.76	2.76	2.69	2.75	2.75	2.64	2.52	2.58	2.58	2.52
	155	 Yemen	Authoritarian	1.95	1.95	1.95	1.95	1.95	1.95	1.95	2.07	2.07	2.24	2.79	2.79	3.12	2.57	2.64
Sub-Saharan Africa	107	 Angola	Hybrid regime	4.05	4.18	3.96	3.37	3.66	3.72	3.62	3.62	3.40	3.35	3.35	3.35	3.35	3.32	3.32
	100	 Benin	Hybrid regime	4.44	4.68	4.28	4.19	4.58	5.09	5.74	5.61	5.67	5.72	5.65	5.87	6.00	6.06	6.17
	35	 Botswana	Flawed democracy	7.63	7.73	7.73	7.73	7.62	7.81	7.81	7.81	7.87	7.87	7.87	7.98	7.85	7.63	7.63
	137	 Burkina Faso	Authoritarian	2.55	2.73	3.08	3.84	3.73	4.04	4.75	4.75	4.70	4.70	4.09	4.15	3.52	3.59	3.59
	144	 Burundi	Authoritarian	2.13	2.13	2.13	2.13	2.14	2.15	2.33	2.33	2.40	2.49	3.33	3.41	3.60	4.01	4.01
	37	 Cape Verde	Flawed democracy	7.58	7.65	7.65	7.65	7.65	7.78	7.88	7.88	7.94	7.81	7.81	7.92	7.92	7.92	7.94
	136	 Cameroon	Authoritarian	2.56	2.56	2.56	2.56	2.77	2.85	3.28	3.61	3.46	3.66	3.41	3.41	3.44	3.41	3.41
	164	 Central African Republic	Authoritarian	1.18	1.18	1.35	1.43	1.32	1.32	1.52	1.52	1.61	1.57	1.49	1.49	1.99	1.82	1.82
	158	 Chad	Authoritarian	1.89	1.67	1.67	1.67	1.55	1.61	1.61	1.50	1.50	1.50	1.50	1.50	1.62	1.62	1.52
	124	 Comoros	Authoritarian	2.84	3.04	3.20	3.20	3.09	3.15	3.71	3.71	3.71	3.71	3.52	3.52	3.52	3.52	3.41

	128	 <u>Republic of the Congo</u>	Authoritarian	2.79	2.79	2.79	2.79	3.11	3.11	3.31	3.25	2.91	2.91	2.89	2.89	2.89	2.89	
	105	 <u>Ivory Coast</u>	Hybrid regime	4.22	4.22	4.22	4.22	4.11	4.05	4.15	3.93	3.81	3.31	3.53	3.25	3.25	3.08	3.02
	156	 <u>Democratic Republic of the Congo</u>	Authoritarian	1.92	1.68	1.48	1.40	1.13	1.13	1.49	1.61	1.93	2.11	1.75	1.83	1.92	2.15	2.15
	132	 <u>Djibouti</u>	Authoritarian	2.70	2.70	2.74	2.74	2.71	2.77	2.87	2.76	2.83	2.90	2.99	2.96	2.74	2.68	2.20
	156	 <u>Equatorial Guinea</u>	Authoritarian	1.92	1.92	1.92	1.92	1.92	1.92	1.92	1.81	1.70	1.77	1.66	1.77	1.83	1.77	1.84
	153	 <u>Eritrea</u>	Authoritarian	1.97	1.97	2.03	2.03	2.15	2.37	2.37	2.37	2.37	2.37	2.44	2.40	2.40	2.34	2.31
	134	 <u>Eswatini</u>	Authoritarian	2.60	2.78	3.01	3.08	3.08	3.14	3.03	3.03	3.03	3.09	3.09	3.20	3.20	3.26	2.90
	116	 <u>Ethiopia</u>	Authoritarian	3.24	3.37	3.17	3.30	3.38	3.44	3.35	3.42	3.60	3.83	3.72	3.83	3.72	3.79	3.68
	143	 <u>Gabon</u>	Authoritarian	2.18	2.18	3.40	3.40	3.54	3.61	3.61	3.61	3.74	3.76	3.76	3.76	3.56	3.48	3.29
	99	 <u>Gambia</u>	Hybrid regime	4.47	4.47	4.47	4.41	4.49	4.33	4.31	4.06	2.91	2.97	3.05	3.31	3.31	3.38	3.38
	65	 <u>Ghana</u>	Flawed democracy	6.24	6.30	6.43	6.50	6.50	6.63	6.63	6.69	6.75	6.86	6.33	6.33	6.02	6.02	6.02
	149	 <u>Guinea</u>	Authoritarian	2.04	2.21	2.32	2.28	3.08	3.14	3.14	3.14	3.14	3.14	3.01	2.84	2.79	2.79	2.79
	150	 <u>Guinea-Bissau</u>	Authoritarian	2.03	2.45	2.56	2.75	2.63	2.63	1.98	1.98	1.98	1.93	1.93	1.26	1.43	1.99	1.99
	89	 <u>Kenya</u>	Hybrid regime	5.05	5.05	5.05	5.05	5.05	5.18	5.11	5.11	5.33	5.33	5.13	5.13	4.71	4.71	4.71
	70	 <u>Lesotho</u>	Flawed democracy	6.06	6.06	6.19	6.30	6.30	6.54	6.64	6.64	6.59	6.59	6.66	6.66	6.66	6.33	6.02
	80	 <u>Liberia</u>	Hybrid regime	5.57	5.57	5.43	5.43	5.32	5.45	5.35	5.23	5.31	4.95	4.95	4.95	4.95	5.07	5.07
	83	 <u>Madagascar</u>	Hybrid regime	5.33	5.26	5.70	5.70	5.70	5.64	5.22	5.11	5.07	4.85	4.42	4.32	3.93	3.93	3.94
	76	 <u>Malawi</u>	Hybrid regime	5.85	5.85	5.91	5.74	5.74	5.50	5.49	5.49	5.55	5.55	5.66	6.00	6.08	5.84	5.84
	139	 <u>Mali</u>	Authoritarian	2.40	2.58	3.23	3.48	3.93	4.92	5.41	5.64	5.70	5.70	5.79	5.90	5.12	6.36	6.01
	108	 <u>Mauritania</u>	Authoritarian	3.96	4.14	4.03	4.03	3.92	3.92	3.82	3.82	3.96	3.96	4.17	4.17	4.17	4.17	3.86
	20	 <u>Mauritius</u>	Full democracy	8.23	8.14	8.14	8.08	8.14	8.22	8.22	8.22	8.28	8.27	8.17	8.17	8.17	8.04	8.04
	113	 <u>Mozambique</u>	Authoritarian	3.38	3.51	3.51	3.51	3.51	3.65	3.85	4.02	4.02	4.60	4.66	4.77	4.88	4.90	4.90
	58	 <u>Namibia</u>	Flawed democracy	6.48	6.52	6.52	6.52	6.52	6.43	6.25	6.31	6.31	6.31	6.24	6.24	6.24	6.24	6.23
	141	 <u>Niger</u>	Authoritarian	2.26	2.37	3.73	3.22	3.29	3.29	3.76	3.76	3.96	4.62	4.02	4.08	4.16	4.16	3.38
	106	 <u>Nigeria</u>	Hybrid regime	4.16	4.23	4.23	4.11	4.10	4.12	4.44	4.44	4.50	3.85	3.76	3.77	3.77	3.83	3.47
	114	 <u>Rwanda</u>	Authoritarian	3.34	3.30	3.10	3.10	3.10	3.16	3.35	3.19	3.07	3.07	3.25	3.38	3.36	3.25	3.25
	74	 <u>Senegal</u>	Hybrid regime	5.93	5.48	5.72	5.53	5.67	5.81	6.15	6.15	6.21	6.08	6.15	6.15	6.09	5.51	5.27
	102	 <u>Sierra Leone</u>	Hybrid regime	4.32	4.32	5.03	4.97	4.86	4.86	4.66	4.66	4.55	4.55	4.56	4.64	4.71	4.51	4.51
	43	 <u>South Africa</u>	Flawed democracy	7.16	7.05	7.05	7.05	7.05	7.24	7.24	7.24	7.41	7.56	7.82	7.90	7.79	7.79	7.79
	86	 <u>Tanzania</u>	Hybrid regime	5.20	5.35	5.10	5.10	5.10	5.16	5.41	5.47	5.76	5.58	5.77	5.77	5.88	5.64	5.64
	121	 <u>Togo</u>	Authoritarian	2.99	2.99	2.99	2.80	2.80	3.30	3.10	3.05	3.32	3.41	3.45	3.45	3.45	3.45	3.45
	98	<u>Uganda</u>	Hybrid regime	4.49	4.49	4.55	4.48	4.94	5.02	5.20	5.09	5.26	5.22	5.22	5.22	5.16	5.13	5.05
	77	<u>Zambia</u>	Hybrid regime	5.73	5.80	5.80	5.72	4.86	5.09	5.61	5.68	5.99	6.28	6.39	6.26	6.26	6.19	5.68
	122	<u>Zimbabwe</u>	Authoritarian	2.98	3.04	2.92	2.92	3.16	3.16	3.16	3.16	3.05	3.05	2.78	2.67	2.67	2.68	2.64
North America	14	 <u>Canada</u>	Full democracy	8.69	8.69	8.88	8.87	9.24	9.22	9.15	9.15	9.15	9.08	9.08	9.08	9.08	9.08	9.08
	28	 <u>United States</u>	Flawed democracy	7.85	7.85	7.85	7.85	7.92	7.96	7.96	7.98	7.98	8.05	8.11	8.11	8.11	8.11	8.18
Western Europe	19	 <u>Austria</u>	Full democracy	8.28	8.28	8.20	8.07	8.16	8.29	8.29	8.42	8.41	8.54	8.54	8.48	8.62	8.49	8.49

34	 <u>Belgium</u>	Flawed democracy	7.64	7.64	7.64	7.51	7.51	7.64	7.78	7.78	7.77	7.93	7.93	8.05	8.05	8.05	8.05
40	 <u>Cyprus</u>	Flawed democracy	7.38	7.38	7.38	7.43	7.56	7.59	7.59	7.59	7.65	7.53	7.40	7.29	7.29	7.29	7.29
7	 <u>Denmark</u>	Full democracy	9.28	9.28	9.28	9.09	9.15	9.22	9.22	9.22	9.20	9.11	9.11	9.38	9.52	9.52	9.52
6	 <u>Finland</u>	Full democracy	9.30	9.30	9.29	9.27	9.20	9.25	9.14	9.03	9.03	9.03	9.03	9.03	9.06	9.06	9.19
26	 <u>France</u>	Flawed democracy	7.99	8.07	8.07	7.99	7.99	8.12	7.80	7.80	7.92	7.92	8.04	7.92	7.88	7.77	7.77
13	 <u>Germany</u>	Full democracy	8.73	8.80	8.80	8.67	8.67	8.68	8.68	8.61	8.63	8.64	8.64	8.31	8.34	8.34	8.38
25	 <u>Greece</u>	Full democracy	8.07	8.14	7.97	7.56	7.39	7.43	7.29	7.29	7.23	7.45	7.45	7.65	7.65	7.65	7.92
4	 <u>Iceland</u>	Full democracy	9.38	9.45	9.52	9.18	9.37	9.58	9.58	9.58	9.50	9.58	9.58	9.65	9.65	9.65	9.65
8	 <u>Ireland</u>	Full democracy	9.19	9.19	9.13	9.00	9.05	9.24	9.15	9.15	9.15	8.85	8.72	8.68	8.56	8.56	8.79
37	 <u>Italy</u>	Flawed democracy	7.58	7.69	7.69	7.68	7.74	7.52	7.71	7.98	7.98	7.98	7.85	7.85	7.74	7.74	7.83
10	 <u>Luxembourg</u>	Full democracy	8.88	8.81	8.81	8.68	8.68	8.81	8.81	8.81	8.81	8.88	8.88	8.88	8.88	8.88	8.88
27	 <u>Malta</u>	Flawed democracy	7.93	7.93	7.70	7.57	7.68	7.95	8.21	8.15	8.39	8.39	8.39	8.28	8.28	8.28	8.28
9	 <u>Netherlands</u>	Full democracy	9.00	9.00	9.00	8.88	8.96	9.01	8.89	8.89	8.80	8.92	8.92	8.84	8.99	8.99	8.99
1	 <u>Norway</u>	Full democracy	9.81	9.81	9.81	9.75	9.81	9.87	9.87	9.87	9.93	9.93	9.93	9.93	9.93	9.80	9.80
23	 <u>Portugal</u>	Full democracy	8.08	7.75	7.95	7.82	7.90	8.03	7.84	7.84	7.86	7.79	7.79	7.65	7.92	7.81	8.02
21	 <u>Spain</u>	Full democracy	8.13	8.07	8.07	7.94	8.12	8.29	8.08	8.08	8.30	8.30	8.05	8.02	8.02	8.02	8.16
3	 <u>Sweden</u>	Full democracy	9.39	9.39	9.39	9.26	9.26	9.39	9.39	9.39	9.39	9.45	9.73	9.73	9.73	9.50	9.50
5	 <u>Switzerland</u>	Full democracy	9.32	9.14	9.14	8.90	8.83	9.03	9.03	9.03	9.09	9.09	9.09	9.09	9.09	9.09	9.09
103	 <u>Turkey</u>	Hybrid regime	4.26	4.33	4.35	4.35	4.48	4.09	4.37	4.88	5.04	5.12	5.12	5.63	5.76	5.73	5.73
17	 <u>United Kingdom</u>	Full democracy	8.34	8.28	8.28	8.10	8.54	8.52	8.53	8.53	8.36	8.31	8.31	8.31	8.21	8.16	8.16

Components

The following table shows the five parameters that made up the score of each nation in 2024 and the changes that had occurred since 2023.^[8]

Full democracies · Flawed democracies · Hybrid regimes · Authoritarian regimes

Year 2024										
Rank	Δ Rank	Country	Regime type	Overall score	Δ Score	Electoral process and pluralism	Functioning of government	Political participation	Political culture	Civil liberties
Full democracies										
1	—	 Norway	Full democracy		—	10.00	9.64	10.00	10.00	9.41
2	—	 New Zealand	Full democracy		—	10.00	9.29	10.00	8.75	10.00
3	▲ 1	 Sweden	Full democracy		—	9.58	9.64	8.33	10.00	9.41
4	▼ 1	 Iceland	Full democracy		▼ 0.07	10.00	8.93	8.89	9.38	9.71
5	▲ 3	 Switzerland	Full democracy		▲ 0.18	9.58	9.29	8.33	10.00	9.41
6	▼ 1	 Finland	Full democracy		—	10.00	9.64	7.78	9.38	9.71
7	▼ 1	 Denmark	Full democracy		—	10.00	9.29	8.33	9.38	9.41
8	▼ 1	 Ireland	Full democracy	9.19	—	10.00	8.21	8.33	10.00	9.41
9	—	 Netherlands	Full democracy	9.00	—	9.58	8.93	8.33	8.75	9.41
10	▲ 1	 Luxembourg	Full democracy	8.88	▲ 0.07	10.00	9.29	6.67	8.75	9.71
11	▲ 3	 Australia	Full democracy	8.85	▲ 0.19	10.00	8.57	7.22	8.75	9.71
12	▼ 2	 Taiwan	Full democracy	8.78	▼ 0.14	10.00	8.57	7.78	8.13	9.41
13	▼ 1	 Germany	Full democracy	8.73	▼ 0.07	9.58	8.21	8.33	8.13	9.41
14	▼ 1	 Canada	Full democracy	8.69	—	10.00	8.21	8.89	7.50	8.82
15	▼ 1	 Uruguay	Full democracy	8.67	▲ 0.01	10.00	9.29	7.78	6.88	9.41
16	—	 Japan	Full democracy	8.48	▲ 0.08	9.58	8.93	6.67	8.13	9.12
17	▲ 1	 United Kingdom	Full democracy	8.34	▲ 0.06	9.58	7.50	8.33	6.88	9.41
18	▼ 1	 Costa Rica	Full democracy	8.29	—	9.58	7.50	7.78	6.88	9.71
19	▼ 1	 Austria	Full democracy	8.28	—	9.58	7.50	8.89	6.88	8.53
20	—	 Mauritius	Full democracy	8.23	▲ 0.09	9.58	7.86	6.11	8.75	8.82
21	▲ 6	 Estonia	Full democracy	8.13	▲ 0.17	10.00	8.57	6.67	6.88	8.53
22	▲ 2	 Spain	Full democracy	8.13	▲ 0.06	9.58	7.50	7.22	7.50	8.82
23	▲ 3	 Czech Republic	Full democracy	8.08	▲ 0.11	9.58	6.43	7.78	7.50	9.12
24	▲ 8	 Portugal	Full democracy	8.08	▲ 0.33	9.58	7.14	6.11	8.75	8.82
25	▼ 5	 Greece	Full democracy	8.07	▼ 0.07	10.00	6.79	7.22	7.50	8.82
Flawed democracies										
26	▼ 3	 France	Flawed democracy	7.99	▼ 0.08	9.58	7.50	7.78	6.88	8.24
27	▲ 1	 Malta	Flawed democracy	7.93	—	9.17	7.14	6.67	8.13	8.53
28	▲ 1	 United States	Flawed democracy	7.85	—	9.17	6.43	8.89	6.25	8.53
29	▼ 4	 Chile	Flawed democracy	7.83	▼ 0.15	9.58	7.86	6.67	5.63	9.41
30	▲ 1	 Slovenia	Flawed democracy	7.82	▲ 0.07	9.58	7.50	7.22	6.25	8.53
31	▼ 1	 Israel	Flawed democracy	7.80	—	9.58	7.50	9.44	6.88	5.59
32	▼ 10	 South Korea	Flawed democracy	7.75	▼ 0.34	9.58	7.50	7.22	5.63	8.82
33	▲ 4	 Latvia	Flawed democracy	7.66	▲ 0.28	10.00	7.14	6.67	6.25	8.24
34	▲ 2	 Belgium	Flawed democracy	7.64	—	9.58	8.21	5.00	6.88	8.53
35	▼ 2	 Botswana	Flawed democracy	7.63	▼ 0.10	9.58	6.43	6.11	7.50	8.53
36	▲ 3	 Lithuania	Flawed democracy	7.59	▲ 0.28	10.00	7.14	6.67	5.63	8.53

37	▼ 2	 Cape Verde	Flawed democracy	7.58	▼ 0.07	9.17	6.64	6.67	6.88	8.53
38	▼ 3	 Italy	Flawed democracy	7.58	▼ 0.11	9.58	7.14	7.22	6.88	7.06
39	▲ 2	 Poland	Flawed democracy	7.40	▲ 0.22	10.00	6.43	6.67	6.25	7.65
40	▼ 3	 Cyprus	Flawed democracy	7.38	—	9.17	5.36	6.67	6.88	8.82
41	—	 India	Flawed democracy	7.29	▲ 0.11	8.67	7.50	7.22	6.88	6.18
42	▲ 2	 Slovakia	Flawed democracy	7.21	▲ 0.14	10.00	6.07	6.11	5.63	8.24
43	▲ 4	 South Africa	Flawed democracy	7.16	▲ 0.11	9.17	6.79	7.78	5.00	7.06
44	▼ 4	 Malaysia	Flawed democracy	7.11	▼ 0.18	9.58	7.14	6.67	6.25	5.88
45	▼ 2	 Trinidad and Tobago	Flawed democracy	7.09	▼ 0.07	9.58	6.79	6.11	5.63	7.35
46	▼ 1	 Timor-Leste	Flawed democracy	7.03	▼ 0.03	9.58	6.07	5.56	6.88	7.06
47	▲ 1	 Panama	Flawed democracy	6.84	▼ 0.07	9.58	5.71	7.22	3.75	7.94
48	▲ 1	 Suriname	Flawed democracy	6.79	▼ 0.09	9.58	5.36	6.67	5.00	7.35
49	▼ 4	 Jamaica	Flawed democracy	6.74	▼ 0.32	8.75	6.43	5.00	5.00	8.53
50	▲ 2	 Montenegro	Flawed democracy	6.73	▲ 0.06	8.75	7.14	6.67	3.75	7.35
51	▲ 2	 Philippines	Flawed democracy	6.63	▼ 0.03	8.75	4.64	8.33	4.38	7.06
52	▲ 9	 Dominican Republic	Flawed democracy	6.62	▲ 0.18	9.17	5.00	7.22	4.38	7.35
53	▲ 6	 Mongolia	Flawed democracy	6.53	▲ 0.05	8.75	5.71	6.67	5.63	5.88
54	—	 Argentina	Flawed democracy	6.51	▼ 0.11	9.17	5.00	6.11	3.75	8.53
55	▼ 4	 Hungary	Flawed democracy	6.51	▼ 0.21	8.75	5.71	4.44	6.88	6.76
56	▲ 2	 Croatia	Flawed democracy	6.50	—	9.17	6.07	6.11	4.38	6.76
57	▼ 6	 Brazil	Flawed democracy	6.49	▼ 0.19	9.58	5.00	6.11	5.00	6.76
58	▼ 1	 Namibia	Flawed democracy	6.48	▼ 0.04	7.42	5.36	6.67	5.00	7.94
59	▼ 3	 Indonesia	Flawed democracy	6.44	▼ 0.09	7.92	6.79	7.22	5.00	5.29
60	▼ 5	 Colombia	Flawed democracy	6.35	▼ 0.20	9.17	5.71	6.11	3.13	7.65
61	▲ 1	 Bulgaria	Flawed democracy	6.34	▼ 0.07	8.75	5.36	5.56	4.38	7.65
62	▲ 10	 North Macedonia	Flawed democracy	6.28	▲ 0.25	8.75	6.07	6.11	3.13	7.35
63	—	 Thailand	Flawed democracy	6.27	▼ 0.08	6.50	5.00	8.33	5.63	5.88
64	—	 Serbia	Flawed democracy	6.26	▼ 0.07	7.83	5.71	6.67	3.75	7.35
65	—	 Ghana	Flawed democracy	6.24	▼ 0.06	8.33	4.64	6.11	6.25	5.88
66	—	 Albania	Flawed democracy	6.20	▼ 0.08	7.00	5.71	5.00	6.25	7.06
67	▲ 3	 Sri Lanka	Flawed democracy	6.19	▲ 0.02	7.00	4.29	7.22	6.25	6.18
68	▲ 1	 Singapore	Flawed democracy	6.18	—	5.33	7.14	4.44	7.50	6.47
69	▼ 2	 Guyana	Flawed democracy	6.11	▼ 0.15	6.92	6.07	6.11	5.00	6.47
70	▲ 1	 Lesotho	Flawed democracy	6.06	—	9.17	3.79	5.56	5.63	6.18
71	▼ 3	 Moldova	Flawed democracy	6.04	▼ 0.19	6.50	5.36	7.22	4.38	6.76
Hybrid regimes										
72	▼ 12	 Romania	Hybrid regime	5.99	▼ 0.46	8.25	5.36	5.56	3.75	7.06
73	▼ 1	 Papua New Guinea	Hybrid regime	5.97	▼ 0.06	6.92	6.07	3.89	5.63	7.35
74	▲ 9	 Senegal	Hybrid regime	5.93	▲ 0.45	7.42	5.36	4.44	6.25	6.18
75	▼ 1	 Paraguay	Hybrid regime	5.92	▼ 0.08	8.33	5.36	6.67	1.88	7.35
76	—	 Malawi	Hybrid regime	5.85	—	7.00	4.29	5.56	6.25	6.18
77	▲ 1	 Zambia	Hybrid regime	5.73	▼ 0.07	7.92	3.29	5.00	6.88	5.59
78	▼ 1	 Peru	Hybrid regime	5.69	▼ 0.12	8.75	5.71	5.00	2.50	6.47
79	▲ 2	 Bhutan	Hybrid regime	5.65	▲ 0.11	8.75	5.93	3.89	5.00	4.71
80	▼ 1	 Liberia	Hybrid regime	5.57	—	7.83	2.71	6.11	5.63	5.59

81	▼ 1	 Fiji	Hybrid regime	5.39	▼ 0.16	6.58	5.00	4.44	5.63	5.29
82	▲ 2	 Armenia	Hybrid regime	5.35	▼ 0.07	7.92	4.29	6.11	3.13	5.29
83	▲ 4	 Madagascar	Hybrid regime	5.33	▲ 0.07	6.58	3.93	6.11	5.63	4.41
84	▲ 6	 Mexico	Hybrid regime	5.32	▲ 0.18	6.92	5.00	7.22	1.88	5.59
85	—	 Ecuador	Hybrid regime	5.24	▼ 0.17	8.75	5.00	5.56	1.88	5.00
86	—	 Tanzania	Hybrid regime	5.20	▼ 0.15	4.42	5.00	5.00	6.88	4.71
87	▲ 1	 Hong Kong	Hybrid regime	5.09	▼ 0.15	2.75	4.00	3.89	6.88	7.94
88	▲ 6	 Bosnia and Herzegovina	Hybrid regime	5.06	▲ 0.06	7.00	3.64	5.00	3.75	5.88
89	▲ 3	 Kenya	Hybrid regime	5.05	—	3.50	5.36	6.67	5.63	4.12
90	▲ 5	 Honduras	Hybrid regime	4.98	—	8.75	3.93	4.44	2.50	5.29
91	▲ 2	 Morocco	Hybrid regime	4.97	▼ 0.05	5.25	4.29	5.56	5.63	4.12
92	▼ 1	 Ukraine	Hybrid regime	4.90	▼ 0.16	5.17	2.71	7.22	5.00	4.41
93	▼ 11	 Tunisia	Hybrid regime	4.71	▼ 0.80	3.42	3.93	5.56	5.63	5.00
94	▼ 5	 Georgia	Hybrid regime	4.70	▼ 0.50	5.67	3.21	5.56	3.75	5.59
95	▲ 1	 El Salvador	Hybrid regime	4.61	▼ 0.10	6.17	3.21	5.56	3.13	5.00
96	▲ 2	 Nepal	Hybrid regime	4.60	—	4.83	5.36	5.00	2.50	5.29
97	▲ 3	 Guatemala	Hybrid regime	4.55	▲ 0.08	6.08	3.93	5.00	1.88	5.88
98	▲ 1	 Uganda	Hybrid regime	4.49	—	3.42	3.57	3.89	6.88	4.71
99	▲ 1	 The Gambia	Hybrid regime	4.47	—	4.42	4.29	3.89	5.63	4.12
100	▼ 25	 Bangladesh	Hybrid regime	4.44	▼ 1.43	6.08	2.57	5.00	5.00	3.53
101	▼ 3	 Benin	Hybrid regime	4.44	▼ 0.24	1.75	5.36	4.44	6.25	4.41
102	▲ 1	 Sierra Leone	Hybrid regime	4.32	—	4.83	2.86	3.89	5.00	5.00
103	▲ 3	 Bolivia	Hybrid regime	4.26	▲ 0.06	4.33	3.93	5.56	1.88	5.59
104	▼ 1	 Turkey	Hybrid regime	4.26	▼ 0.07	3.50	4.64	6.11	5.00	2.06
105	—	 Ivory Coast	Hybrid regime	4.22	—	4.33	2.86	4.44	5.63	3.82
106	▼ 2	 Nigeria	Hybrid regime	4.16	▼ 0.07	5.17	3.57	3.89	3.75	4.41
107	—	 Angola	Hybrid regime	4.05	▼ 0.13	4.50	2.86	5.56	5.00	2.35
Authoritarian regimes										
108	—	 Mauritania	Authoritarian regime	3.96	▼ 0.18	3.50	3.21	5.56	3.13	4.41
109	▲ 3	 Lebanon	Authoritarian regime	3.56	—	3.08	0.79	6.67	3.13	4.12
110	—	 Algeria	Authoritarian regime	3.55	▼ 0.11	3.08	2.50	3.33	5.00	3.82
111	▼ 2	 Kyrgyzstan	Authoritarian regime	3.52	▼ 0.18	3.42	1.86	3.89	3.13	5.29
112	▲ 3	 Palestine	Authoritarian regime	3.44	▼ 0.03	1.58	0.00	8.33	3.75	3.53
113	—	 Mozambique	Authoritarian regime	3.38	▼ 0.13	1.67	1.43	5.56	5.00	3.24
114	▲ 3	 Rwanda	Authoritarian regime	3.34	▲ 0.04	1.42	4.29	3.33	5.00	2.65
115	▲ 7	 Jordan	Authoritarian regime	3.28	▲ 0.24	3.08	2.86	4.44	2.50	3.53
116	—	 Ethiopia	Authoritarian regime	3.24	▼ 0.13	0.42	2.86	6.11	5.63	1.18
117	▼ 6	 Qatar	Authoritarian regime	3.17	▼ 0.48	0.00	3.93	2.78	5.63	3.53
118	▲ 2	 Kazakhstan	Authoritarian regime	3.08	—	0.50	3.21	5.00	3.75	2.94
119	▲ 6	 United Arab Emirates	Authoritarian regime	3.07	▲ 0.06	0.00	4.29	2.78	5.63	2.65
120	▼ 1	 Oman	Authoritarian regime	3.05	▼ 0.07	0.08	3.57	2.78	5.00	3.82

121	▲ 5	 <u>Togo</u>	Authoritarian regime	2.99	—	0.92	2.14	3.33	5.63	2.94
122	—	 <u>Zimbabwe</u>	Authoritarian regime	2.98	▼ 0.06	0.00	2.50	4.44	5.00	2.94
123	▼ 2	 <u>Cambodia</u>	Authoritarian regime	2.94	▼ 0.11	0.00	2.36	5.00	5.00	2.35
124	▼ 2	 <u>Comoros</u>	Authoritarian regime	2.84	▼ 0.20	0.83	2.21	3.89	3.75	3.53
125	▼ 6	 <u>Pakistan</u>	Authoritarian regime	2.84	▼ 0.41	0.83	4.29	2.78	2.50	3.82
126	▲ 4	 <u>Azerbaijan</u>	Authoritarian regime	2.80	—	0.50	2.50	3.33	5.00	2.65
127	▲ 2	 <u>Iraq</u>	Authoritarian regime	2.80	▼ 0.08	4.83	0.00	6.11	1.88	1.18
128	▲ 3	 <u>Republic of the Congo</u>	Authoritarian regime	2.79	—	0.00	2.50	4.44	3.75	3.24
129	▼ 1	 <u>Egypt</u>	Authoritarian regime	2.79	▼ 0.14	0.42	2.86	3.89	5.00	1.76
130	▼ 16	 <u>Kuwait</u>	Authoritarian regime	2.78	▼ 0.72	0.92	3.21	2.78	3.75	3.24
131	▼ 2	 <u>Haiti</u>	Authoritarian regime	2.74	▼ 0.07	0.00	0.29	2.78	5.63	5.00
132	▲ 2	 <u>Djibouti</u>	Authoritarian regime	2.70	—	0.00	1.64	3.89	5.63	2.35
133	▲ 3	 <u>Vietnam</u>	Authoritarian regime	2.62	—	0.00	3.93	2.78	3.75	2.65
134	▼ 2	 <u>Eswatini</u>	Authoritarian regime	2.60	▼ 0.18	0.00	1.64	2.78	5.63	2.94
135	—	 <u>Cuba</u>	Authoritarian regime	2.58	▼ 0.07	0.00	2.86	3.33	3.75	2.94
136	▲ 2	 <u>Cameroon</u>	Authoritarian regime	2.56	—	0.33	2.14	3.89	4.38	2.06
137	▼ 4	 <u>Burkina Faso</u>	Authoritarian regime	2.55	▼ 0.18	0.00	2.14	3.33	3.75	3.53
138	▲ 1	 <u>Bahrain</u>	Authoritarian regime	2.45	▼ 0.07	0.42	2.36	3.33	4.38	1.76
139	▼ 2	 <u>Mali</u>	Authoritarian regime	2.40	▼ 0.18	0.00	0.00	5.00	4.38	2.65
140	▲ 17	 <u>Libya</u>	Authoritarian regime	2.31	▲ 0.53	1.25	0.00	3.89	3.75	2.65
141	—	 <u>Niger</u>	Authoritarian regime	2.26	▼ 0.11	0.33	1.14	1.67	3.75	4.41
142	—	 <u>Venezuela</u>	Authoritarian regime	2.25	▼ 0.06	0.00	1.07	5.00	3.13	2.06
143	▲ 3	 <u>Gabon</u>	Authoritarian regime	2.18	—	0.83	1.14	2.22	3.75	2.94
144	▲ 3	 <u>Burundi</u>	Authoritarian regime	2.13	—	0.00	0.00	3.89	5.00	1.76
145	▲ 3	 <u>China</u>	Authoritarian regime	2.11	▼ 0.01	0.00	3.21	3.33	3.13	0.88
146	▲ 2	 <u>Uzbekistan</u>	Authoritarian regime	2.10	▼ 0.02	0.00	1.86	2.78	5.00	0.88
147	▼ 4	 <u>Nicaragua</u>	Authoritarian regime	2.09	▼ 0.17	0.00	2.14	2.78	3.75	1.76
148	—	 <u>Saudi Arabia</u>	Authoritarian regime	2.08	—	0.00	3.57	2.22	3.13	1.47
149	▼ 4	 <u>Guinea</u>	Authoritarian regime	2.04	▼ 0.17	0.00	0.43	3.33	4.38	2.06
150	▼ 10	 <u>Guinea-Bissau</u>	Authoritarian regime	2.03	▼ 0.42	2.17	0.00	2.78	3.13	2.06
151	▼ 6	 <u>Russia</u>	Authoritarian regime	2.03	▼ 0.19	0.00	2.14	2.22	3.75	2.06
152	▼ 1	 <u>Belarus</u>	Authoritarian regime	1.99	—	0.00	0.79	3.33	4.38	1.47
153	▼ 1	 <u>Eritrea</u>	Authoritarian regime	1.97	—	0.00	2.14	0.56	6.88	0.29
154	▼ 1	 <u>Iran</u>	Authoritarian regime	1.96	—	0.00	2.50	3.33	2.50	1.47
155	▼ 1	 <u>Yemen</u>	Authoritarian regime	1.95	—	0.00	0.00	3.89	5.00	0.88
156	▲ 4	 <u>Democratic Republic of the Congo</u>	Authoritarian regime	1.92	▲ 0.24	2.08	0.43	2.78	3.13	1.18

157	—	 Equatorial Guinea	Authoritarian regime	1.92	—	0.00	0.43	3.33	4.38	1.47
158	▲ 3	 Chad	Authoritarian regime	1.89	▲ 0.22	0.00	0.00	3.33	3.75	2.35
159	▼ 4	 Tajikistan	Authoritarian regime	1.83	▼ 0.11	0.00	2.21	1.67	4.38	0.88
160	▼ 1	 Laos	Authoritarian regime	1.71	—	0.00	2.86	1.67	3.75	0.29
161	▲ 1	 Turkmenistan	Authoritarian regime	1.66	—	0.00	0.79	2.22	5.00	0.29
162	▼ 4	 Sudan	Authoritarian regime	1.46	▼ 0.30	0.00	0.00	1.11	5.63	0.59
163	—	 Syria	Authoritarian regime	1.32	▼ 0.11	0.00	0.00	2.22	4.38	0.00
164	—	 Central African Republic	Authoritarian regime	1.18	—	0.00	0.00	1.67	1.88	2.35
165	—	 North Korea	Authoritarian regime	1.08	—	0.00	2.50	1.67	1.25	0.00
166	—	 Myanmar	Authoritarian regime	0.96	▲ 0.11	0.00	0.00	1.67	3.13	0.00
167	—	 Afghanistan	Authoritarian regime	0.25	▼ 0.01	0.00	0.00	0.00	1.25	0.00

Countries not listed

The Democracy Index does not cover some UN member states, namely [Andorra](#), [Antigua and Barbuda](#), [the Bahamas](#), [Barbados](#), [Belize](#), [Brunei](#), [Dominica](#), the Federated States of Micronesia, [Grenada](#), [Kiribati](#), [Kosovo](#), [Liechtenstein](#), the Maldives, the Marshall Islands, [Monaco](#), [Nauru](#), [Palau](#), [Saint Kitts and Nevis](#), [Saint Lucia](#), [Saint Vincent and the Grenadines](#), [Samoa](#), [San Marino](#), [São Tomé and Príncipe](#), [Seychelles](#), [Solomon Islands](#), [Somalia](#), [South Sudan](#), [Tonga](#), [Tuvalu](#), and [Vanuatu](#).^{[9][10]}

Recent changes

In 2016, the United States was downgraded from a full democracy to a flawed democracy;^[11] its score, which had been declining for some years, crossed the threshold from 8.05 in 2015 to 7.98 in 2016. The report stated that this was caused by myriad factors dating back to at least the late 1960s which have eroded Americans' trust in governmental institutions.^{[12][13]} Nigeria was also upgraded from an authoritarian regime to a hybrid regime.

The 2017 *Democracy Index* registered, at the time, the worst year for global democracy since 2010–11. Asia was the region with the largest decline since 2016. Venezuela was downgraded from a hybrid regime to an authoritarian regime. In China, [Xi Jinping](#), General Secretary of the Chinese Communist Party (CCP), further entrenched his power by writing his contribution to the CCP's ideology, dubbed [Xi Jinping Thought](#), into the party's constitution. Moldova was downgraded from a flawed democracy to a hybrid regime as a result of problematic elections. By contrast, Armenia was re-upgraded from an authoritarian regime to a hybrid regime as a result of constitutional changes that shifted power from the presidency to parliament.^[14] The Gambia was upgraded again from an authoritarian regime to a hybrid regime after [Yahya Jammeh](#), who was president from 1996 to 2017, was defeated by [Adama Barrow](#), an opposition candidate in the 2016 presidential elections.

In 2019, France, Portugal and Chile were upgraded from flawed democracies to full democracies. In fact, this was not a new experience for the former two, which suffered from the [eurozone crisis](#) many years before. By contrast, Malta was downgraded from a full democracy to a flawed democracy. Thailand and Albania were upgraded from hybrid regimes to flawed democracies.^[15] Algeria was upgraded again from an authoritarian regime to a hybrid regime.

In 2020, Taiwan was upgraded from flawed democracy to full democracy following judicial reforms,^[16] and soared to 11th (8.94) position from its previous position at 33rd (7.73), surpassing [Switzerland](#), which ranked 12th. Japan and South Korea were also upgraded again to full democracies, while France and Portugal were once again relegated to flawed democracies. Hong Kong was downgraded from a flawed democracy to a hybrid regime. Algeria was downgraded again from a hybrid regime to an authoritarian regime. The Economist Intelligence Unit noted that democracy "was dealt a major blow in 2020".^[17] Almost 70% of countries covered by the *Democracy Index* recorded a decline in their overall score, as most of them imposed [lockdowns](#) and other restrictions in response to the [COVID-19 pandemic](#), in addition to some arresting journalists and citizens accused of spreading [COVID-19 misinformation](#). The global average score fell to its lowest level since the index began in 2006.

In 2021, both the global and regional average scores continued downward trends, with the exception of the Central and Eastern Europe region. Spain and Chile were downgraded from full democracies to flawed democracies, while Ecuador, Mexico, Paraguay, and Tunisia were downgraded from flawed democracies to hybrid regimes. Haiti, Lebanon, and Kyrgyzstan were downgraded from hybrid regimes to authoritarian regimes. In addition, Moldova, Montenegro, and North Macedonia were upgraded from hybrid regimes to flawed democracies, whereas Mauritania was upgraded from authoritarian to hybrid regime. For the first time, North Korea was displaced as the lowest-ranked state in the Democracy Index, with Myanmar and Afghanistan recording scores lower than North Korea due to [a military coup](#) and the [2021 Taliban offensive](#) and subsequent takeover of government respectively.

In 2022, the global average score stagnated, with the lifting of COVID-related restrictions being largely canceled out by other negative developments globally.

In 2023, the global average score deteriorated further, with most declines occurring in authoritarian and hybrid regimes, with the former becoming more entrenched and the latter struggling to democratize. The threshold for each color has also been changed from greater than the integer to greater than or equal to.^[18]

In 2024, the global average once again trended downwards, largely due to continued and expanded crackdowns in dissent in authoritarian regimes. The average score for democracies remained the same, despite 2024 being a major election year. One of the most notable declines was South Korea's decline from a full democracy to a flawed democracy, which was majorly a result of the political crisis caused by President Yoon Suk Yeol's declaration of martial law in December. Romania's score fell by 0.46 points to 5.99 after controversially cancelling a presidential election, making it the first EU member state to be classified as a hybrid regime. The Czech Republic's score rose from 7.97 to 8.08, which reupgraded it to a full democracy.^[19]

See also

- Corruption Perceptions Index
- Democracy-Dictatorship Index
- Democracy promotion
- Democracy Ranking
- Democratic backsliding by country
- Gallagher index

References

- Geissel, Brigitte; Kneuer, Marianne; Lauth, Hans-Joachim (2016). "Measuring the quality of democracy: Introduction" (<https://www.jstor.org/stable/26556872>). *International Political Science Review*. **37** (5). Sage Publications: 571–579. doi:10.1177/0192512116669141 (<https://doi.org/10.1177%2F0192512116669141>). ISSN 0192-5121 (<https://search.worldcat.org/issn/0192-5121>). JSTOR 26556872 (<https://www.jstor.org/stable/26556872>). S2CID 151808737 (<https://api.semanticscholar.org/CorpusID:151808737>). Retrieved 3 April 2023.
- Democracy Index 2023 – Age of conflict* (<https://www.eiu.com/n/campaigns/democracy-index-2023>). The Economist Intelligence Unit. 15 February 2024. pp. 65–77. Retrieved 17 November 2024.
- "Democracy Index 2010: Democracy in retreat" (https://graphics.eiu.com/PDF/Democracy_Index_2010_web.pdf) (PDF). Economist Intelligence Unit. 6 December 2010. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20171213120004/http://graphics.eiu.com/PDF/Democracy_Index_2010_web.pdf) (PDF) from the original on 13 December 2017. Retrieved 26 January 2017.
- "Democracy Index 2006" (https://www.economist.com/media/pdf/DEMOCRACY_INDEX_2007_v3.pdf) (PDF). *The World in 2007*. 15 November 2006. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20170202052528/https://www.economist.com/media/pdf/DEMOCRACY_INDEX_2007_v3.pdf) (PDF) from the original on 2 February 2017. Retrieved 26 January 2017.
- Manae, Oleg; Manayeva, Natalie; Dzmityr, Yuran (1 December 2011). "More State than Nation: Lukashenko's Belarus" (<https://jia.sipa.columbia.edu/more-state-nation-lukashenkos-belarus>). *Journal of International Affairs*. **65** (1): 93–113. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20161221152959/https://jia.sipa.columbia.edu/more-state-nation-lukashenkos-belarus>) from the original on 21 December 2016. Retrieved 26 January 2017.
- "Democracy Index 2015: Democracy in an age of anxiety" (<http://www.yabiladi.com/img/content/EIU-Democracy-Index-2015.pdf>) (PDF). The Economist Intelligence Unit. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20160305143559/http://www.yabiladi.com/img/content/EIU-Democracy-Index-2015.pdf>) (PDF) from the original on 5 March 2016. Retrieved 26 January 2017.
- "Democracy Index 2024" (<https://www.eiu.com/n/campaigns/democracy-index-2024/>). *EIU.com*. Retrieved 27 February 2025.
- "Democracy Index 2024 – What's wrong with representative democracy?" (<https://image.b.economist.com/lib/fe8d13727c61047f7c/m/1/609fbc8d-4724-440d-b827-2c7b7300353d.pdf>) (PDF). *Economist Intelligence Unit*. 2025.
- "Democracy Index 2023: Age of conflict" (<https://pages.eiu.com/rs/753-RIQ-438/images/Democracy-Index-2023-Final-report.pdf>) (PDF). *Economist Intelligence Unit*. 2024. p. 3.
- "Member States" (<https://www.un.org/en/about-us/member-states>). UN. United Nations. Retrieved 27 April 2024.
- Karlis, Nicole (31 January 2018). "New report classifies US as a "flawed democracy" – Partisanship and Trump were to blame for the US's dismal ranking in the Economist's annual Democracy Index report" (<https://www.salon.com/2018/01/31/new-report-classifies-us-as-a-flawed-democracy/>). *Salon*. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20180216090019/https://www.salon.com/2018/01/31/new-report-classifies-us-as-a-flawed-democracy/>) from the original on 16 February 2018. Retrieved 17 February 2018.
- Eshe Nelson (25 January 2017). "The US has been downgraded to a "flawed democracy," but not just because of Trump" (<https://qz.com/894362/america-has-been-downgraded-to-a-flawed-democracy-but-not-because-of-trump-economist-intelligence-unit-says>). Quartz. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20171001030916/https://qz.com/894362/america-has-been-downgraded-to-a-flawed-democracy-but-not-because-of-trump-economist-intelligence-unit-says/>) from the original on 1 October 2017. Retrieved 30 September 2017.
- "Declining trust in government is denting democracy" (<https://www.economist.com/blogs/graphicdetail/2017/01/daily-chart-20>). *The Economist*. 25 January 2017. Archived (<https://web.archive.org/web/20170714014551/https://www.economist.com/blogs/graphicdetail/2017/01/daily-chart-20>) from the original on 14 July 2017. Retrieved 13 July 2017.
- "Democracy Index 2017: Free speech under attack" (https://www.eiu.com/public/topical_report.aspx?campaignid=DemocracyIndex2017). *ei.u.com*. The Economist Intelligence Unit. Archived (https://web.archive.org/web/20180131181010/https://www.eiu.com/public/topical_report.aspx?campaignid=DemocracyIndex2017) from the original on 31 January 2018. Retrieved 31 January 2018.
- "Democracy Index 2019 A year of democratic setbacks and popular protest" (https://www.eiu.com/public/topical_report.aspx?campaignid=democracyindex2019). *EIU.com*. Retrieved 24 January 2020.
- "Taiwan most democratic country in East Asia: The Economist" (<https://www.taiwannews.com.tw/en/news/4118874>). 3 February 2021. Retrieved 8 February 2021.
- "Democracy Index 2020: In sickness and in health?" (<https://www.eiu.com/n/campaigns/democracy-index-2020/>). *EIU.com*. Retrieved 2 February 2021.
- "The Economist Group – EIU's 2023 Democracy Index: Conflict and polarisation drive a new low for global democracy" (<https://www.economistgroup.com/group-news/economist-intelligence/eius-2023-democracy-index-conflict-and-polarisation-drive-a-new-low-for>).
- "EIU's 2024 Democracy Index: trend of global democratic decline and strengthening authoritarianism continues through 2024" (<https://www.eiu.com/n/democracy-index-2024/>). *Economist Intelligence Unit*. 27 February 2025. Retrieved 8 April 2025.

External links

- EIU Democracy Index (<https://www.eiu.com/n/global-themes/democracy-index/>)

Retrieved from "https://en.wikipedia.org/w/index.php?title=The_Economist_Democracy_Index&oldid=1337342394"